

easier, because you'll have something to hold you. You won't feel like you're going into freefall every time money is a challenge, nor will you be lost for ideas if a little extra money comes into your life.

I find there is a common theme across every 'method' for improving your life, whether it's a tidying technique, mindfulness exercise or way of eating, which is that most life-changing things are *habits*, rather than events. They require repetition in order to make a lasting difference, and there's no quick or single fix. It's the same for looking after your financial wellbeing – once you've done the deeper work on your mindset and overcoming limiting beliefs about your ability to successfully manage your money, the magic lies in how you make it happen. How you continue to show up for yourself when it comes to money.

Creating lasting money habits and rituals

I try not to spend too much time dwelling on the practicalities of budget-building because a) there are so many free templates and guides out there and b) the hard part is actually maintaining it or 'sticking to it'. A lot of the language that we use around money and budgeting is similar to how we talk about food and dieting, with discipline held in the highest regard and any deviation from 'ideal' treated as game-changing or deal-breaking. Serial budgeters tend to apply the same all-or-nothing application to finances as yo-yo dieters